CONFERENCE-DAY OPERATIONS

1. Understanding Your Role

Every volunteer will be assigned a specific role for the conference day. Before the conference, volunteers must understand:

- What their responsibilities are
- Where they need to be
- What time they need to report
- Who they are working with
- What they are allowed to handle independently
- Who they should contact if an issue arises

Golden Rule: Do your assigned role first. If something goes wrong, follow the escalation chain instead of trying to solve an issue outside your responsibility.

2. Registration & Check-In

Relevant volunteers should be trained on the complete registration process.

Registration Flow

- Welcome the delegate/participant.
- Confirm their name and registration details.
- Verify the required information.
- Direct them to the appropriate registration/check-in point.
- Provide their required conference materials.
- Direct them to the correct waiting area or room.
- Report any missing or incorrect information to the designated registration lead.

Volunteers should know:

- Where registration is located
- How to check registration details
- How to handle missing names/details
- Where to direct late arrivals
- Who to contact for registration problems

Do not make changes to registration records unless authorized.

3. Social Night QR & Check-In Training

The team handling Social Night should receive separate training from the IT/technical team.

Volunteers should know:

- How the QR check-in system works
- How to scan a participant's QR code
- What to do if the QR code does not scan
- How to identify whether someone is registered
- What to do if a participant's name does not appear
- Who to contact for technical issues
- How to manage the check-in line without creating confusion

If the system stops working:

- Do not repeatedly attempt random fixes.
- Contact the designated IT/technical person and inform the Social Night lead.

4. Delegate Movement

Volunteers are responsible for helping maintain an organised flow of delegates around the venue.

They should know:

- Which rooms are being used by each committee
- Where delegates should go during breaks
- Where delegates are allowed to wait
- Which areas are restricted
- How to direct delegates between committee rooms and common areas
- How to prevent unnecessary crowding outside committee rooms

Important:

Volunteers should direct, not unnecessarily control, delegates.

If a delegate refuses to follow instructions or there is a serious issue, contact the designated senior organiser instead of escalating the situation themselves.

5. Room Management

Room-management volunteers should ensure that committee rooms remain organised.

Responsibilities may include:

- Checking that the room is ready before the session
- Ensuring required materials are available
- Helping maintain quiet outside the room
- Managing entry and exit when instructed
- Informing the relevant team if materials or equipment are missing
- Reporting technical or logistical problems

Volunteers should not:

- Interrupt committee proceedings unnecessarily
- Give procedural instructions to delegates
- Overrule the Chair/Dias
- Handle disciplinary situations independently

The Chair/Dias controls the committee. Volunteers support the operation of the room.

6. Security & Safety

Operations volunteers help maintain a safe and secure conference environment. They should be aware of potential safety concerns and know the correct procedures for responding to them.

Volunteers should know:

- Where the main entrances, exits, and emergency exits are located
- Which areas are restricted
- Where the designated emergency assembly point is
- Who the designated security/faculty contact is
- How to respond if an unauthorised person enters a restricted area
- What to do if a delegate is injured or becomes unwell
- What to do if an evacuation or other emergency is announced

For security or safety concerns, volunteers should **not**:

- Physically confront or restrain anyone
- Search individuals or their belongings
- Attempt to investigate serious incidents
- Provide medical assistance beyond their training
- Take independent action during an emergency

Instead, volunteers should **maintain a safe distance, prevent unnecessary crowding where possible, and immediately use the established escalation chain.**

During an evacuation, volunteers should follow the instructions of faculty/security personnel, help direct delegates towards the designated assembly point, and ensure that emergency exits and pathways remain clear.

Golden Rule: Operations volunteers support security by **observing, directing, and reporting**. They are not responsible for independently handling security or emergency situations.

7. Escalation Procedure

One of the most important things volunteers must understand is who to contact when something goes wrong.

Follow the chain:

Volunteer → Assigned Team Lead → Relevant Head/Organiser → Senior Organiser/Faculty

The exact chain should be given to volunteers before the conference.

Examples:

Registration problem

→ Registration Team Lead

QR/technical problem

→ IT/Technical Lead

Room/material problem

→ Logistics/Room Management Lead

Delegate movement problem

→ Delegate Affairs/Operations Lead

Serious behavioural or safety concern

→ Senior Organiser/Faculty

Golden Rule:

Do not independently approach teachers unless your escalation procedure tells you to.

This prevents multiple volunteers from approaching teachers with the same problem and ensures that issues reach the correct person quickly.

8. Handling Unexpected Problems

Volunteers should use a simple process:

STOP → ASSESS → REPORT → FOLLOW INSTRUCTIONS

STOP: Do not immediately panic or take action outside your role.

ASSESS: Understand what has actually happened.

REPORT: Contact the appropriate person through the escalation chain.

FOLLOW: Carry out the instructions given by the responsible organiser.

Example:

A delegate says their committee room is locked.

Do not leave your assigned position and start searching for another room.

Instead:

Check the situation → Contact your team lead → Inform the delegate of the next step → Follow the instructions given.

9. Final Conference Briefing

Before the conference begins, all volunteers should attend a final briefing.

The briefing should cover:

- Individual roles
- Reporting times
- Locations
- Team leads
- Communication channels
- Emergency contacts
- Registration procedures
- Delegate movement
- Room management
- Social Night procedures
- QR/check-in system
- Escalation chain
- Break/lunch arrangements
- What to do during unexpected situations

Every volunteer should leave the briefing knowing:

- Where do I need to be?
- What do I need to do?
- Who do I report to?
- Who do I contact if something goes wrong?

10. Conference-Day Communication

Volunteers should communicate clearly and briefly.

When reporting an issue, provide:

- WHO — Who is involved?
- WHAT — What happened?

- WHERE — Where is it happening?
- WHEN — When did it happen?
- ACTION — What has already been done?

Example:
“Two delegates from UNHRC cannot find their assigned room. They are currently at the main registration area. I have kept them here and informed the Delegate Affairs Lead.”
This is much more useful than simply saying:
“There is a problem with some delegates.”

11. Volunteer Conduct

All volunteers are expected to:

- Be punctual
- Stay at their assigned location
- Remain professional
- Communicate respectfully
- Follow the chain of command
- Avoid unnecessary interference with committees
- Keep delegate information confidential
- Ask for help when unsure
- Remain calm during unexpected situations

A good volunteer is not the person who tries to solve everything themselves. A good volunteer is the person who knows what to do, what not to do, and who to contact.